Military Leadership Attributes

Quick briefing

Recall the three leader attributes and use observable behavior to identify which one a leader needs to strengthen.

Know the facts

Character · The moral and ethical qualities that guide decisions and conduct, including empathy and the warrior ethos.

Philippine Army Core Values · Honor guides conduct, patriotism expresses allegiance to country and Constitution, and duty calls for conscientious performance and initiative.

Presence · The impression a leader projects through military and professional bearing, health and physical fitness, confidence, and resilience.

Resilience · The physical and psychological capacity to recover from adversity.

Intellect · The mental resources a leader draws on to understand situations. The lesson includes mental agility, sound judgment, innovation, tact, and domain knowledge.

Understand the reasoning

A composed briefing can build confidence while still revealing a gap in sound judgment if the leader ignores relevant evidence.

Feedback works better when it describes a behavior and its effect. A leader can practice making a timely decision from incomplete information more readily than trying to become more decisive in general.

Philippine Army classroom exercise

During a Philippine Army classroom exercise, a platoon leader calmly briefs a schedule even after a junior soldier points out that two groups need the same training room.

Decision · Which attribute is the leader demonstrating, and which part of the model should the instructor help develop?

Worked analysis · The calm delivery demonstrates confidence under presence. The schedule problem calls for sound judgment and mental agility under intellect. Have the leader verify the conflict and adjust the sequence while preserving the training objective. This keeps the briefing credible and uses the junior soldier's observation.

Check yourself

What are the three leader attributes? · Character, presence, and intellect.

How do mental agility and innovation differ? · Mental agility is flexibility of thought under changing conditions. Innovation introduces a new idea, method, or approach.

Course source

Military Leadership Attributes (CPI)